

**Pre-examination Training for SC/ST/OBC Candidates under Regular Recruitment
Drive for Junior Associates**

English Language Set- 5

Directions (51-59) Read the given passage carefully and answer the following questions. Certain parts have been highlighted to help answer the questions.

Marina was extremely afraid of the dark. When the lights went out, everything and every **shadow** appeared to her as the most terrible of monsters. Her parents explained to her, everyday and with great patience, that these things were not monsters. Marina understood her parents, but she could not stop feeling an awful fear whenever it was dark. One day her Aunt Valerie came to visit. Valerie was an incredible woman. She was famous for her courage, and for having gone on many journeys of adventure, some of which had been made into books and movies. Marina wanted to conquer her fear of the dark, so she asked her Aunt how she became so brave, and whether she had ever been frightened. "A great many times, Marina," answered her Aunt, "I remember when I was small and I was terribly afraid of the dark. I couldn't stay in the dark for even a moment".

Marina became very excited. How was it possible that someone so courageous could have been afraid of the dark? "I'll tell you a secret, Marina. It was some blind children who taught me how to be brave. They can't see, so if they had never discovered the secret of how not to be afraid of the dark, they would have been forever frightened". "It's true!" said Marina, intrigued, "Can you tell me that secret?" "Of course! The secret is to change your eyes. Since blind children can't see, their hands are their eyes. All you have to do to conquer your fear is what they do. Shut the eyes of your face and open the eyes of your hands. Let's make a deal: tonight, when you go to bed and put out the light, if anything makes you afraid, close your eyes, carefully get out of bed, and try to see what it is that's making you scared. But do it using your hands as eyes... and tomorrow tell me how you're getting on with the fear".

Marina accepted, but she was rather worried. She knew she would need to be brave to close her eyes and go and touch whatever it was that was frightening her; but she was willing to try because she was already too old for this. When her parents took her to bed, she herself **put out** the light. After a little while, she felt afraid of one of the shadows in the bedroom. Following the advice of Aunt Valerie, she closed the eyes of her face and _____(A)_____. And, summoning up all her courage, she went over to **grab** that mysterious shadow. The next morning Marina came running into the kitchen, a big smile on her face, and a song on her lips. "The monster is so soft and smooth!..." she cried, "It's my teddy bear!"

51. How did Merina feel after receiving explanation in context of darkness from her parents?

- (a) she became even more anxious due to her fear overpowering her
- (b) she felt relaxed and was prepared to face her fear of darkness

- (c) she woke up feeling happy next day, for not being afraid and overcoming her fear of darkness
- (d) things didn't change and a gush of fear still ran through her every time when it was dark
- (e) none of these

52. What was Aunt Valerie's stance regarding her childhood experiences of darkness?

- (a) she had learnt to ignore her fear and focus on her studies
- (b) she was never afraid of darkness which finally helped her become a courageous woman
- (c) she too was scared of shadows and darkness and always wanted to stay in light
- (d) all are correct
- (e) none of these

53. The blind children overcome their fears by-

- (a) they try to shut eyes of hands and open eyes of face
- (b) using their hands to throw off what makes them afraid
- (c) using their hands as their eyes so as to feel what they are afraid of
- (d) putting their hands on their eyes so that they could not feel anything
- (e) all are correct

54. Why was it necessary for blind children to learn not to be afraid of darkness?

- (a) they were destined to be blind forever and spend their life without having any fears
- (b) if they don't learn how not to be afraid of darkness, they would be scared throughout their life
- (c) if they ever had opportunity to see again they must be able to recognize the things around them
- (d) both (a) and (b)
- (e) none of these

55. Why was Merina willing to use the technique told by Aunt Valerie?

- (a) she wanted to make Aunt Valerie happy for trying to overcome her fear
- (b) she wanted to face her fear and be courageous like her parents
- (c) she was too old to be afraid of darkness
- (d) she was constantly told to do so by her parents
- (e) none of these

56. Which of the following phrases could fit in the blank (A) to make the statement grammatically correct and contextually meaningful?

- (a) treated by experiencing shadows
- (b) social gatherings would feel anxious
- (c) fear passes from person to person
- (d) opened the eyes of her hands
- (e) none of these

Directions (57-59): Which of the following word/ phrase can replace the highlighted word, as used in the passage given above to infer the similar meaning?

57. Shadow

- (a) gloom
- (b) interference
- (c) refraction
- (d) mirage
- (e) reflection

58. Put Out

- (a) blow out
- (b) switch off
- (c) extinguish
- (d) smother
- (e) none of these

59. Grab

- (a) obtain
- (b) gather
- (c) grasp
- (d) achieve
- (e) purchase

Directions (60-64): In each of the following questions given below, a sentence is given with some bold words which may contain errors. Below each of the sentence, a table is given with two columns in which column 'A' contains the list of bold words, and in column 'B' the suggested corrections are listed. You have to choose the best alternate among the four given options. If no correction is required against the given bold words, mark (e) .i.e. "None of the above" as your answer.

60. The Indian telecom sector has witnessed a **Paranoid** shift—crossing the billion-user mark and **rolling** out new technologies along with other leading markets. Just four years ago, it **faced** multiple challenges—falling revenues and increasing debt were wreaking **triumph**.

COLUMN A

- (1) Paranoid (2) Rolling
(3) Faced (4) Triumph

COLUMN B

- (5) Paradigm (6) Rolled
(7) Face off (8) Havoc
(a) Both (1) - (5) and (4) – (8)
(b) (2) – (6)
(c) (1) – (5)

- (d) (3-7)
- (e) None of the above

61. The government launched Tarang Sanchar portal to correct **mislead** around electromagnetic emissions from towers. It allows people to check **emission** (EMF) **consensus** status of mobile towers, giving **information** about any site, on request, via email.

COLUMN A

- (1) Mislead (2) Emissions
- (3) Consensus (4) Information

COLUMN B

- (5) Misconceptions (6) Eminences
- (7) Compliance (8) Informed

- (a) (4) – (8)
- (b) (2) – (6)
- (c) (1) – (5)
- (d) Both (1) - (5) and (3-7)
- (e) None of the above

62. India has told messaging platform WhatsApp to get serious about **hawking** the purveyors of fake news and **variance** rumours. In a meeting with one of its top **hosts**, the law minister **stressed** that over 20 lives had been lost in India due to this rumour-mongering.

COLUMN A

- (1) Hawking (2) Variance
- (3) Hosts (4) Stressed

COLUMN B

- (5) Tracking (6) Vicious
- (7) Honchos (8) Guessed

- (a) (4) – (8)
- (b) (2) – (6)
- (c) (1) – (5)
- (d) (1) - (5), (2) – (6) and (3-7)
- (e) None of the above

63. Preserving, changing social structures, **raising** disposable incomes, industrial growth and infrastructure expansion, **coupled** with the easy availability of housing loans, are the drivers of decorative paints industry, which accounts for 75% of the **estimated** \$8.2-billion Indian market.

COLUMN A

- (1) Preserving (2) Raising
- (3) Coupled (4) Estimated

COLUMN B

- (5) Urbanisation (6) Rising

- (7) Caused (8) Estimation
 (a) (4) – (8)
 (b) (2) – (6)
 (c) Both (1) - (5) and (2) – (6)
 (d) (1) - (5), (2) – (6) and (3-7)
 (e) None of the above

64. It is important to measure the **outstanding** risk of a company and find the best possible solution to **hedge** and manage it. **Had** locked in a major portion of the costs can give paint manufacturers a significant margin boost to achieve **compete** pricing and hence healthy functioning.

COLUMN A

- (1) Outstanding (2) Hedge
 (3) Had (4) Compete

COLUMN B

- (5) Outdated (6) Wedge
 (7) Having (8) Competitive
 (a) (4) – (8)
 (b) (2) – (6)
 (c) Both (3) - (7) and (4) – (8)
 (d) (1) - (5), (2) – (6) and (3-7)
 (e) None of the above

Directions (65-69): A word has been given in each question and has been used in the sentences given below. Identify the statements where the word has been used in a contextually and grammatically correct manner. If the word has been used incorrectly in all the statements, mark (e), “None of these”, as your answer.

65. Thrive

- (i) To survive and thrive after COVID-19, community networks are the key
 (ii) Thriving is a cool concept because it encompasses the component of both development and success.
 (iii) A lady IPS officer has also thrive the State Home Minister of taking money for transfers and postings.
 (a) only (i)
 (b) only (ii)
 (c) both (ii) and (i)
 (d) both (i) and (iii)
 (e) none of these

66. Reconcile

- (i) Due to the pain and burns, victim reconcile consciousness after four-five minutes.

(ii) Company is coming up with the approaches that really reconcile some of the challenge it is facing.

(iii) The Indian Tea Association has reconcile the daily wage of tea plantation workers in Assam to `193.

- (a) only (ii)
- (b) both (i) and (ii)
- (c) both (ii) and (iii)
- (d) all (i), (ii), (iii)
- (e) None of these

67. Convalesce

(i) Prague city hall has rented a luxury hotel where homeless people who contract COVID-19 can convalesce.

(ii) The victim has criminal background and was convalesce in murder and robbery cases.

(iii) The patient has now returned to convalesce with her family and as rates of infection have dropped so much.

- (a) both (i) and (ii)
- (b) both (i) and (iii)
- (c) only (iii)
- (d) only (ii)
- (e) None of these

68. Repudiate

(i) He BSES discoms have repudiate its Delhi consumers to switch off all non-essential lights and electrical appliances for an hour.

(ii) Iran strongly repudiate unsubstantiated allegations over claims of its involvement

(iii) Norwegian Air is seeking to repudiate three aircraft sales contracts with Boeing as part of its restructuring process.

- (a) only (iii)
- (b) both (i) and (ii)
- (c) both (ii) and (iii)
- (d) all (i), (ii), (iii)
- (e) none of these

69. Exacerbate

(i) The future requirement of digital documentation that demonstrates Covid-19 vaccine status may exacerbate inequality.

(ii) Slow solar rollout exacerbating grid supply concerns

(iii) Physical masks may even exacerbate racial bias

- (a) both (i) and (ii)
- (b) both (i) and (iii)
- (c) only (iii)
- (d) only (ii)
- (e) all (i), (ii), (iii)

Directions (70-74): In each of the questions given below, a paragraph is given which has some blanks and those blanks have to be filled with the same word out of five words given below it. You have to choose that same word as your answer and fill up the blanks with that appropriate word.

70. By the 12th century a _____ referred to as Tanka was introduced. Later on, the Indian Rupee was adopted as the country's sole _____, and the use of other domestic coinage was removed from circulation. Our _____ rankings show that the most popular India Rupee exchange rate is the USD to INR rate.

- (a) Money
- (b) Currency
- (c) Worth
- (d) Value
- (e) Rupees

71. _____ education debt is a big issue in health care. _____ schools themselves are addressing the student debt problem. However, there is an array of government programs that help students afford _____ school or that forgive student loan.

- (a) Business
- (b) Economics
- (c) Science
- (d) Law
- (e) Medical

72. The largest chunk of the _____ population is made of daily wage earners, not farmers, the report said, adding that an equal focus on both _____ wages and farm income is vital to relieve _____ distress.

- (a) Poor
- (b) Rural
- (c) Agricultural
- (d) Advanced
- (e) Insolvent

73. The much-anticipated New Industrial _____, which will replace the 27-year-old existing _____ and pave the way for promotion of new technology and reduced regulations, has been placed before the Union Cabinet for approval. This will be the third industrial _____ drafted in independent India.

- (a) Policy
- (b) Procedures

- (c) Meeting
- (d) Practices
- (e) Group

74. Lead with the _____ of one individual who works there and what it took for her to get that job and how that job has made her life better. It was a _____, not topic, about a high-powered woman who had persevered and triumphed. More importantly, it was a _____ I wanted to read and knew other readers would too.

- (a) Autobiography
- (b) Record / Reports
- (c) Fiction
- (d) Article
- (e) Story

Directions (75-77): In the following questions a part of a sentence is given in bold, it is then followed by four sentences which try to explain the meaning of the idiom/phrase given in bold. Choose the alternative from the four given below each question which explains the meaning of the phrase correctly without altering the meaning of the sentence given as question. If none of the sentence explains the meaning of the highlighted phrase, choose option (e) i.e., “none of these” as your answer choice.

75. I contemplate long and hard before I decide if I feel ready to tackle a new skill or if I prefer to let sleeping dogs lie.

- (a) I scrutinize thoroughly before I choose if I am ready to pursue a new skill or if I prefer to ignore it to avoid even more difficult situation.
- (b) I examine extensively before I determine, if I want to follow a new skill or if I choose to capture the hidden capabilities.
- (c) I study very hard while establishing whether I feel qualified to adapt a new skill or if I am inexperienced to assimilate it.
- (d) I forecast thoroughly before I decide that if I am ready to tackle a new skill or if I choose to let the dogs sleep.
- (e) None of these

76. If you want to respond but feel like the cat got your tongue, I spoke with experts to create an unofficial, evolving script we could use when we face a variety of icky situations.

- (a) If you want to respond but feel like you could clamor, I spoke with experts to create an unofficial, evolving script we could use when we face a variety of icky situations.
- (b) If you want to respond but feel like the cat held your tongue, I spoke with experts to create an unofficial, evolving script we could use when we face a variety of icky situations.
- (c) If you want to respond but feel like you could only mutter, I spoke with experts to create an unofficial, evolving script we could use when we face a variety of icky situations.

- (d) If you want to respond but feel like you can't answer anything, I spoke with experts to create an unofficial, evolving script we could use when we face a variety of icky situations.
- (e) None of these

77. President Paul Biya has been acting like a cat on hot bricks or better still a mother who returns from a long journey just to find her plates in disarray.

(a) President Paul Biya has been acting anxious like a mother who returns from a long journey just to find her plates in disarray.

(b) President Paul Biya has been acting poised as if a mother who returns from a long journey just to find her plates in disarray.

(c) President Paul Biya's mother is suppressed after returning from a long journey just to find her plates in disarray.

(d) President Paul Biya is a mother who returns from a long journey just to find her plates in disarray and is distressed about it.

(e) None of these

Directions (78-82): Read the following passage, few blanks have been provided which have to be filled according to the options given below in such a manner that they provide grammatical and contextual meaning to the sentences.

Once there was a very good little girl who lived with her parents in a small bamboo house. One day she was **(78)** over a basket of paddy drying in the sun in front of her house when a large golden crow flew up and ate every grain.

"Oh dear, oh dear," cried the little girl said. "My parents and I will go hungry now with no rice to eat."

The golden crow felt sorry and gave her directions to come to his nest to get payment for the paddy. The next day the little girl walked into the forest as instructed and saw a very tall tree with a crow's nest high in the branches. The crow was waiting for her and said he would let down a ladder for her.

"Do you want a ladder of gold or silver or wood?" he asked.

"A wooden one, thank you," the little girl said for she has never seen ladders of gold or silver before. But the crow let down a ladder of gold.

When she **(79)** the nest, the crow offered her a drink of sweet juice.

"Would you like it from a gold cup, a silver cup or a clay cup?" he asked.

"A clay cup, thank you," the little girl said for she has never seen cups of gold or silver. But the crow gave her drink in a cup of gold.

The crow then **(80)** her plate of rice cakes.

"Would you like it on a gold plate, a silver plate or a clay plate?" he asked.

"A clay plate, thank you," the little girl said for she has never seen plates of gold or silver. But the crow gave her cakes on a plate of gold.

Finally, the crow showed her three bags, big, medium and small. The crow **(81)** that she take the big bag and she came home with it. When she and her parents opened it, it was full of rubies and they became very rich.

"This is your payment," he said. "Please choose a bag. "Meanwhile, their next-door neighbours heard the story and their daughter was made to sit in front of the house to watch over a handful of **(82)** paddy. The golden crow ate up the paddy and the girl demanded payment.

- 78.** (a) running
(b) falling
(c) waiting
(d) watching
(e) jogging

- 79.** (a) below
(b) dried
(c) reached
(d) dived
(e) cried

- 80.** (a) talked
(b) offered
(c) declared
(d) damaged
(e) called

- 81.** (a) insisted
(b) refused
(c) burned
(d) surround
(e) trim

- 82.** (a) speedy
(b) deleted
(c) frying
(d) drying
(e) dusting

Directions (83-87): In each of the given questions, a word has been highlighted in the statement. In the options given below, a pair of words has been given. Find the pair of the word where the first word is the synonym of the highlighted word whereas the second word is the antonym of the given word.

83. Valour and sacrifice of the Armed Forces will be honoured at this year's India Day parade, the largest parade outside India to mark the country's independence that brings

together thousands of members of the diaspora for one of the biggest cultural extravaganzas in the US.

- (a) timidity: wimpiness
- (b) audacity: fortitude
- (c) gallantry: cojone
- (d) bravery: cowardice
- (e) none of these

84. Veteran attorneys interviewed by the Guardian said Epstein's death would not **impede** federal prosecutors from pursuing conspiracy cases against others.

- (a) extol: substitute
- (b) facilitate: hinder
- (c) withstand: surrender
- (d) abstruse: remission
- (e) restrain: expedite

85. The U.S. **appreciates** Turkey and Russia's efforts to reach a cease-fire in Idlib's de-escalation zone and underlined that the attacks targeting civilians must stop

- (a) asinine: recuperate
- (b) rectify: avenge
- (c) acknowledge: disparage
- (d) tarnish: eschew
- (e) exaggerate: entail

86. During the outing, Isha was seen donning a simple yet **elegant** white kurta and palazzo set with floral print and gold gotta patti work from the house of Sabyasachi.

- (a) diminutive: prolific
- (b) graceful: gauche
- (c) conceit: timid
- (d) handy: redundant
- (e) none of these

87. Farmers **abhor** selling corn at harvest, Utterback acknowledges. "But getting rid of 2019 corn sooner than later would be prudent — don't hold onto it until next summer," he says.

- (a) commend: derelish
- (b) applaud: acclaim
- (c) abominate: execrate
- (d) loathe: admire
- (e) disdain: despise

Directions for (88-90): In each sentences there are five sentences. The sentence labelled A is in the correct place. The four that follow are labelled B, C,D and E and need to be arranged in the logical order to form a coherent passage. From the given options, choose the most appropriate option.

88.

- (A) Hard times hit the most vulnerable sections of a society
- (B) The crisis, as the UNFPA report "Reaching Common Ground: Culture , Gender and Human Rights"
- (C) Two recently published global studies are timely reminders that gender inequalities, which persist in varying degrees across the world, are a dampener on economic growth, and that they should not be overlooked in the looming global economic downturn
- (D) The inequalities are shocking. Nearly 60 percent of the world's one billion poorest people are women and girls 66% of adult illiterates are women and 70% of the out-of-school children are girls.
- (E) The reposts, one by the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), and the other by the World Economic Forum (WEF), differ in their approach to this global reality, but agree with the point that there are compelling advantages flowing from the empowerment of women.

- (a) BECD
- (b). DCEB
- (c). CEDB
- (d). CEBD
- (e). EFBD

89.

- (A) The fall in the external value of the rupee in relation to the dollar has been overshadowed by catastrophic events in the international financial markets
- (B) The fast-paced developments in the US and other developed markets markets have important consequences for the emerging financial markets such as India's
- (C) The Central Banks and governments around the world have been focussing exclusively on the unfolding financial sector crisis originating from the United States. Although it is more than a year since the sub prime crisis surfaced, it assumed mencacing proportions only recently as seen in the failures of iconic financial institutions in the US prompting monetary authorities to resort to some bold unconventional measures to save some of them
- (D) India stock market indices, along with those of most of the stock markets of Asia, declined sharply, although they would recover later

(E) The extreme loss of investor confidence, coupled with serious disruption in the international money markets, has caused a flight of capital from emerging markets in search of safety

1. CBED
2. CEDB
3. BCDE
4. CBDE
5. BECD

90.

(A) It may be difficult for us to imagine how the earth, which appears to us to be a solid mass of complexly interrelated parts, may be having an intention to purify and can be undergoing a process we normally associate with human beings on a spiritual path.

(B) The 'great purification' of the earth has been spoken of by the Hopi and other indigenous people as a prelude to a great transition of life and consciousness that the planet shall go through. This transition has also been prophesied within other ancient traditions as well as by individual seers

(C) Today, in midwest United States where massive flooding is taking place, and not too long ago in the West where fires raged out of control or in the South where hurricanes took a heavy toll on the populace, weather patterns have become quite extreme.

(D) And even if it is true of the planetary body, we may well wonder how this happens and how it can affect weather patterns.

(E) The purification to which those ancient ones refer is happening all around us. It is revealed in the altered weather patterns that are becoming commonplace around the globe.

1. BEDC
2. DBEC
3. BDEC
4. DEBC
5. DCBE

ANSWERS

51. (d) It is mentioned in the passage, "Her parents explained to her, everyday and with great patience, that these things were not monsters. Marina understood her parents, but she could not stop feeling an awful fear whenever it was dark." Referring to the quoted text, we can infer that the statement given in option (d) is most suitable choice in context of the given question. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer choice.

52. (c) It is mentioned in the passage, "'A great many times, Marina," answered her Aunt, "I remember when I was small and I was terribly afraid of the dark. I couldn't stay in the dark for even a moment'." Referring to the quoted text, we can infer that the statement given in option (c) is appropriate in context of the given question. Hence, option (c) is the most suitable answer choice.

53. (c) It is mentioned in the passage, "Since blind children can't see, their hands are their eyes. All you have to do to conquer your fear is what they do. Shut the eyes of your face and open the eyes of your hands." As per the information available in the given passage, we can infer that option (c) is the most suitable answer choice.

54. (b) It is mentioned in the passage, "It was some blind children who taught me how to be brave. They can't see, so if they had never discovered the secret of how not to be afraid of the dark, they would have been forever frightened'." Referring to the quoted text, we can infer that the statement given in option (b) is most suitable in context of the given question. Hence, option (b) is the most suitable answer choice.

55. (c) It is mentioned in the passage, "She knew she would need to be brave to close her eyes and go and touch whatever it was that was frightening her; but she was willing to try because she was already too old for this." Referring to the quoted text, we can infer that the statement given in option (c) is correct in context of the information available in the passage.

56. (d) Among the given phrases, the most suitable phrase to fill in the blank will be 'opened the eyes of her hands'. The hint can be gathered from the previous statements, where Aunt Valerie mentions that blind children use the eyes of hands. No other phrase could make the statement both grammatically correct and contextually meaningful. Hence, option (d) is the most suitable answer choice. **57. (e)** Among the given words, 'reflection' can replace 'shadow' to give a similar meaning to the statement, as given in the passage. Hence, option (e) is the most suitable answer choice.

58. (b) Put out means "to stop something from burning or shining". Here, it has been used in context of the lights, where 'switch off' can aptly replace to infer the similar meaning. Also, 'extinguish' cannot fit in the given blank as it will make the statement grammatically incorrect. Hence, option (b) is the most suitable answer choice.

Extinguish- to make a fire stop burning or a light stop shining

Blow out- if a flame, etc. blows out, it is put out by the wind, etc

59. (c) Among the given words, 'grasp' can replace 'grab' to give a similar meaning. Although other words are synonymous with 'grab' but they would not give the similar meaning to the statement. Hence, option (c) is the most suitable answer choice.

60. (a); The sentence is describing about a shift in the technology in the telecom industry. It has also mentioned about the challenges faced by the industry few years ago. Therefore, to adhere to the context of the sentence “paranoid” should be replaced by “paradigm” while “triumph” should be replaced by “havoc”. Hence, option (a) is the most suitable answer choice.

Paranoid means unreasonably or obsessively anxious, suspicious, or mistrustful.

Triumph means a great victory or achievement.

Paradigm means a typical example or pattern of something; a pattern or model.

Havoc means widespread destruction.

61. (d); Words “mislead” and “consensus” create a contextual error in the sentence and thus should be replaced by “misconceptions” and “compliance” respectively. Hence, option (d) is the most suitable answer choice.

Emissions means the production and discharge of something, especially gas or radiation.

Consensus means a general agreement.

Eminences means to fame or acknowledged superiority within a particular sphere.

Compliance means the action or fact of complying with a wish or command.

62. (d); The words given in bold “hawking”, “variance” and “hosts” create either grammatical or contextual error in the sentence. To correct the sentence, replace these words by “tracking”, “vicious” and “honchos” respectively. Hence, option (d) is the most suitable answer choice.

Hawking means (of a person) hunt game with a trained hawk.

Variance means the fact or quality of being different, divergent, or inconsistent.

Vicious means deliberately cruel or violent.

Honchos means a leader or manager; the person in charge.

63. (c); Since the sentence is describing about the developments and advancements made in the recent time, the bold words “preserving” and “raising” create grammatical as well as contextual errors in the sentence. To make the sentence correct, replace these words by “urbanization” and “rising” respectively. Therefore, option (c) becomes the most suitable answer choice.

64. (c); The words given in bold “had” and “compete” create either grammatical or contextual error in the sentence. To correct the sentence, replace these words by “having” and “competitive” respectively. The sentence is given in the present tense [...can give paint manufacturers], it requires a gerund [Having] that works as a subject in the sentence, therefore, “had” should be replaced to frame a grammatically correct structure of the sentence. Moreover, to describe the quality of “pricing” an adjective [competitive] is required rather than a verb [compete]. Hence, option (c) is the most suitable answer choice.

65. (c): Thrive means ‘prosper; flourish’ hence its use is correct in statement (i) and statement (ii). In statement (iii), ‘thrive’ should be ‘accused’.

66. (a): ‘Reconcile’ means ‘to find a way of dealing with two ideas, situations, statements, etc.’ Hence its use is incorrect in statement (i) and (iii). In statement (i), it should be ‘lost’ and in statement (iii), it should be ‘enhanced’.

67. (b): 'Convalesce' means 'to rest and get better over a period of time after an illness' hence its use is correct in statement (i) and in statement (ii) therefore the correct answer is option (b).

In statement (ii), 'convalesce' should be 'involved'.

68. (c): 'Repudiate' means 'to say that you refuse to accept or believe something', hence its use is correct in statement (ii) and in statement (iii) therefore the correct answer is option (c).

In statement (i), 'repudiate' should be 'urged'.

69. (e): 'Exacerbate' means 'to make something worse, especially a disease or problem' hence its use is correct in all three statements. Therefore, the correct answer is option (e).

70. (b): The most suitable word that will fit in all the three blanks of the paragraph is "currency". All the words are however seem similar but have little difference and thus does not fit contextually in the sentence. Hence, option (b) is the most suitable answer choice. Money means a current medium of exchange in the form of coins and banknotes; coins and banknotes collectively.

Currency means a system of money in general use in a particular country.

Worth means equivalent in value to the sum or item specified.

Value means the regard that something is held to deserve; the importance, worth, or usefulness of something.

Rupees means the basic monetary unit of India

71. (e): The most appropriate word that should fill all the three blanks of the paragraph is "medical". Since, the alternatives provide different streams of education; the most suitable one to adhere to the context of the paragraph is "medical". This is indicated from the phrase of the first sentence "...big issue in health care". Hence, option (e) is the most viable answer choice.

72. (b): The most appropriate word that should fill all the blanks of the sentence is "rural". All the other words are either grammatically incorrect or contextually. Hence, option (b) is the most suitable answer choice.

Advanced means far on or ahead in development or progress.

Insolvent means unable to pay debts owed.

73. (a): The most appropriate word that should fill all the blanks of the sentence is "policy". All the other words are either grammatically incorrect or contextually. Hence, option (a) is the most suitable answer choice.

Policy means a course or principle of action adopted or proposed by an organization or individual.

Procedure means an established or official way of doing something.

Practice means the actual application or use of an idea, belief, or method, as opposed to theories relating to it.

74. (e): The most appropriate word that should fill all the blanks of the sentence is "story". All the other words are either grammatically incorrect or contextually. Hence, option (e) is the most suitable answer choice.

Autobiography means an account of a person's life written by that person.

Fiction means literature in the form of prose, especially novels, that describes imaginary events and people.

75. (a); The most appropriate sentence that is grammatically and contextually viable in accordance to the meaning of the given sentence is sentence (a) as, the meaning of the phrase “to let sleeping dogs lie” is to ignore a problem because trying to deal with it could cause an even more difficult situation. All the other sentences are contextually incorrect; hence, option (a) is the most suitable answer choice.

76. (d); The most appropriate sentence that is grammatically and contextually viable in accordance to the meaning of the given sentence is sentence (d) as, the meaning of the phrase “cat got your tongue” is used when someone has nothing to say. All the other sentences are contextually incorrect; hence, option (d) is the most suitable answer choice.

77. (a); The most appropriate sentence that is grammatically and contextually viable in accordance to the meaning of the given sentence is sentence (a) as, the meaning of the phrase “cat on hot bricks” is used to express when someone is restless or skittish, unable to remain still. All the other sentences are contextually incorrect; hence, option (a) is the most suitable answer choice.

78. (d) From the given options, only option (d) fits to make a contextually meaningful sentence, remaining options render no meaning to the paragraph. The given sentence talks about the little girl keep a watch at the basket of paddy drying in front of the sun, rest of the options do not fit in the given context other than the mentioned in the answer.

Watching: look at or observe attentively over a period of time.

79. (c) From the given options, only option (c) fits to make a contextually meaningful sentence, remaining options render no meaning to the paragraph.

Dived: plunge head first into water with one's arms raised over one's head.

Reached: arrive at; get as far as.

80. (b) From the given options, only option (b) fits to make a contextually meaningful sentence, remaining options render no meaning to the paragraph.

Offered: present (something) for (someone) to accept or reject as desired.

Demanded: insist on having

81. (a) From the given options, only option (a) fits to make a contextually meaningful sentence, remaining options render no meaning to the paragraph. In the given sentence the crow as a mark of his guilt insists the girl to take the bigger bag which she later finds out to contain gemstones.

Insisted: demand something forcefully, not accepting refusal.

Trim: make (something) neat or of the required size or form by cutting away irregular or unwanted parts.

Surround: all round a particular place or thing.

82. (d) From the given options, only option (d) fits to make a contextually meaningful sentence, remaining options render no meaning to the paragraph. The sentence talks about the neighbours hearing the story of the girl and make their daughter sit outside to watch over drying paddy, hoping they might also find the crow who will make them rich. All the other options present do not make any contextual sense.

Drying: a mass transfer process consisting of the removal of water or another solvent by evaporation from a solid, semi-solid or liquid.

83. (d); Among the given words, “**bravery**” is synonym of valour and **cowardice** is antonym of valour. Hence, option (d) is the most suitable answer choice.

84. (e); Among the given words, “**restrain**” is synonym of impede and **expedite** is antonym of impede. Hence, option (e) is the most suitable answer choice.

85. (c); Among the given words, “**acknowledge**” is synonym and **disparage** is antonym of **appreciates**. Hence, option (c) is the most suitable answer choice.

86. (b); Among the given words, “**graceful**” is synonym and **gauche** is antonym of **elegant**. Hence, option (b) is the most suitable answer choice.

87. (d); The correct answer choice will be (d). Here, ‘loathe’ is synonym of ‘abhor’ whereas ‘admire’ is its antonym.

Abhor: regard with disgust and hatred.

Loathe: feel intense dislike or disgust for

88. (d): Choice (d) is the logical sequence as Statement C elaborates on what is stated in A by saying that the ‘hard times’ refers to the global economic downturn and the ‘vulnerable sections’ are those affected by the ‘gender inequalities’ referred to in C.

89. (a): Statement C follows A as it elaborates on the ‘calamitous events in the international financial markets’ - mentioned in A. Hence CBED is the correct sequence.

90. (c): B follows A linked by the reference to purification. It is a more generalised statement than D and so a better one to follow A. D follows B, ‘it’ referring to the purification and it introduces the idea of weather pattern which are continued in E and C. Thus BDEC is the correct sequence.